

Grunt

A warm drive stage that keeps the low end tight and the mids clear.



Overview

Grunt is a simple drive stage with a warm, sunrise-orange faceplate. Turn up GAIN and the signal is pushed through a soft pre-clip and a cubic waveshaper that adds weight and harmonics, then through a band saturator on the way out.

Two things keep it from turning to mush. The sub band below 140 Hz is split off and, the higher GAIN goes, the more of it skips the drive altogether (up to 85% at full GAIN) - so the bottom stays tight and un-fuzzed. And as GRUNT and SAG pile up harmonics, a dynamic dip at 330 Hz pulls out up to about 6 dB there, so heavy settings don't go boxy.

Reach for it for

- Adding weight and grit to bass, synths and drum loops
- Warming up a bus or a dull source
- Heavier drive that keeps a tight low end
- Quick amp-style crunch on guitars and keys

Controls

The six knobs sit in three printed groups on a recessed strip. Hover over a knob and its label shows the value.

PREAMP

GAIN	The drive into the stage, from -24 to +12 dB. It sets the level going in and how hard the waveshaper is pushed. The higher it goes, the more of the sub-140 Hz band bypasses the drive (none at the bottom of the travel, up to 85% at the top), so the low end stays clean under heavy drive.
BOOST (small knob, gold pointer)	Extra drive on top of GAIN, 0 - 100%. It also adds an asymmetric bias, so it brings in even harmonics for a warmer, rounder tone.

CHARACTER

GRUNT	How much cubic waveshaping character is added, 0 to 1. More GRUNT means thicker, more saturated harmonics. Together with SAG it also deepens the dynamic 330 Hz dip.
SAG	The bias of the output saturation, 0 to 1: more SAG gives more even harmonics and a rounder, warmer colour. It also adds to the 330 Hz dip.

OUTPUT

SQUASH	The amount of band saturation in the output stage, 0 to 1. Only the lows (below about 90 Hz) and the highs (above about 7.5 kHz) are saturated; the mids pass clean.
MASTER	Output level, -24 to +12 dB.
Meter	At the right of the strip. Output level, left and right side by side, rising from the bottom, with a floating peak. Click it to clear the peak.

The header

PRESETS, arrows and display	PRESETS (or a click on the display) opens the list of factory presets; the ◀ / ▶ keys step through them. The display shows the preset number and name.
S / M / L	Panel size: small, medium or large. The panel also scales to fit the plugin window.
?	Opens a pop-up with the design credit, the GFX website address and the address of this manual. Click anywhere to close it.

The input guard is always on in Grunt: very hot sources are eased down before the drive, so a loud track won't overload it. A soft clipper on the output (always on) catches overs at the ceiling.

Presets

Default	The starting point: GAIN at 0 dB, no BOOST, medium GRUNT and SQUASH, soft clipper on the output.
Warm Console	+6 dB GAIN, full BOOST, light GRUNT with more SAG and SQUASH for a warm, rounded colour.
American Crunch	+9 dB GAIN, full BOOST and heavy GRUNT for a bright, biting crunch; little SAG, soft clipper.
British Punch	+4 dB GAIN, no BOOST, medium GRUNT with more SAG and SQUASH for a punchy, thick tone.

Tips

- Because the sub band skips the drive more as GAIN rises, you can push bass and kick hard without the bottom turning fuzzy.
- Reach for BOOST rather than more GAIN when you want warmth as well as drive - its bias adds even harmonics.
- If heavy settings sound too thin in the low mids, back GRUNT and SAG off a little: they control how far the 330 Hz dip cuts.

- Use MASTER to match the level with the plugin bypassed, so you judge the tone and not the loudness.

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